TEACHER GUIDE

SQA Higher Business Management (C810 76)

# Recruitment and training

Management of people
**Workforce planning; Training and development**



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise recruitment and training on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

## The lesson

**45-minute setting**

| Setup | Round 1 | Round 2 | Round 3 | Final questions |
|---|---|---|---|---|

### EVERY ROUND

**Firm decisions**
3 min

→

**Deals**
4½–5 min

→

**Topic tasks**
4 min

→

**B2B deal**
2½ min
from Round 2

### LESSON SETTINGS

| 30 min | 45 min | 60 min | 75 min |
|---|---|---|---|

# What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



## CEO

**Staff · Sabotage** from Round 2



## Finance

**Capital & Loans · Investments**



## Sales & Marketing

**Marketing**



## Operations

**Seasonal stock**

# Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same. Your Live screen shows each task and every firm's answer.

## 1 Promotion risk

Round 1

You promote your best salesperson to sales manager.

**Which risk is most likely?**

- **A** They do not know the firm
- **B** High advertising costs
- **C** Staff see no route to promotion
- **D** You must replace your top seller

**ANSWER**

**✓ You must replace your top seller**

**Why:** Internal promotion leaves a gap where the best seller used to sell.

## 2 Cost of turnover

Round 1

Labour turnover at your firm doubled this year.

**Which two costs are most likely to rise?**

- **A** Hiring and training new staff
- **B** Lost sales while new staff learn
- **C** Overtime to cover idle staff
- **D** Pensions for long-serving staff
- **E** Redundancy pay

**ANSWER**

**✓ Hiring and training new staff**
**✓ Lost sales while new staff learn**

**Why:** Each leaver must be replaced and trained, and new staff sell less at first.

## 3 Labour turnover

Round 2

Three branches: staff on average, and how many left this year.

**Order by labour turnover, lowest first?**

- **A** 50 staff, 10 leavers
- **B** 24 staff, 6 leavers
- **C** 80 staff, 12 leavers

**ANSWER**

**1. 80 staff, 12 leavers**
**2. 50 staff, 10 leavers**
**3. 24 staff, 6 leavers**

**Why:** Turnover 15%, 20%, 25%: the fewest leavers is the highest rate.

# Topic tasks

## 4 Staff to recruit

Round 2

Plan the workshop staff for next year.

**How many must you recruit?**

| | |
|---|---|
| Technicians needed next year | **23 staff** |
| Technicians now | **20 staff** |
| Labour turnover a year | **25%** |

**ANSWER**

**8 staff**

25% of 20 = 5 leave; 23 − 15 = 8

**Why:** Recruit for growth and for the staff who leave.

## 5 Full or part time

Round 3

Most buyers come on Saturdays; weekdays are quiet.

**Which staffing should you choose, and why?**

**A** Part-time staff for weekends

**B** More full-time staff all week

**ANSWER**

**✓ Part-time staff for weekends**

**Why:** Part-time staff match the cost of staff to the busy times.

## 6 Why a role-play

Round 3

Applicants must sell a car to a manager in a role-play before any job offer.

**Why is this better than an interview alone?**

**A** It attracts more applicants

**B** It replaces induction training

**C** It tests the skill the job needs

**D** It is cheaper than an interview

**ANSWER**

**✓ It tests the skill the job needs**

**Why:** A role-play shows how well each applicant sells, so selection is more reliable.

# Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on recruitment and training. They come from these 8 questions.

1 A dealer promotes its best salesperson to sales manager instead of advertising outside. What is a main advantage?
✔ **The person already knows the business**

2 A workshop needs an EV specialist no current employee can become quickly. Why recruit externally?
✔ **It brings skills the firm does not have**

3 A document lists the duties and reporting line of a service adviser. What is it?
✔ **A job description**

4 Which item belongs in a person specification for a technician?
✔ **A recognised vehicle technician qualification**

5 What is induction training for a newly hired sales adviser?
✔ **Introducing the firm, its rules and systems**

6 Technicians learn a new diagnostic system at the maker's training centre for three days. Which type of training is this?
✔ **Off-the-job training**

7 Training six technicians costs £900 each plus £350 of lost output each. The dealer expects £9,000 extra profit in the first year. What is the first-year net gain?
✔ **£1,500**

8 A dealer's new recruits keep leaving within three months. Which change to selection is most likely to help?
✔ **Use a realistic work trial before offering the job**